

Rules, Policy and Equity Subcommittee Meeting
Via Zoom
February 10, 2021
Notes

Paul Ruseau: Chair

Roll: Jenny Graham, Melanie McLaughlin, Paul Ruseau: three present

1) Finalization of the annual reports and presentations schedule: 4:05 pm

Paul Ruseau sharing screen with reports and presentation schedule for SC meetings:

Goal of Calendar: Minimize duplication of requests and inquiries; organizational tool for administrators for meeting planning.

Need: Insert a link on the web page to a definitions page for acronyms, educational, financial and legal language.

Schedule will be unreadable without explanation of terms.

Items in Chart: Name, meeting type, Statutory?, Description, timing, frequency, special details

Paul Ruseau: details of reports on chart. There are question marks (blank fields) we can leave open and have administrators fill in.

Meeting type: Regular/COW/Special Meeting/Subcommittee Meeting/Budget Meeting

Jenny Graham: Items requiring financial review need to have enough time allocated to handle the content. Whether it is a COW or a regular meeting.

Bullying Presentation: Paul Ruseau; regular meeting for maximum visibility

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: I agree

Capital Improvement Plan: Paul Ruseau: This has been COW in the past. Do we want to keep it that way?

Jenny Graham: I haven't seen us get to the point where we have a functional capital improvement plan. Until we get a cadence down, I would keep it as a COW.

Grievances Report:

How many have there been? Historically? Resolution? This can be just a report.

Melanie McLaughlin: This is making me think of the legal issues involved. Sincerely when things have been filed, gone to hearing, legal action and expenditures.

Pre-Budget: Paul Ruseau: I feel like we had the Pre-Budget presentation on Monday night?

Jenny Graham: I think it is our series of pre - budget meetings where we go through the items. Yes it is a kick off of budget season. Last year, we had a meeting about what we wanted to see in the budget. I think we did a bit of that on Monday night.

Melanie: it is both and. Monday night's presentation would be the beginning of the pre-budget. There should be a post-budget as well.

School Open House Schedule: can be a presentation and report. Should I break it out into three categories (elementary, middle and high school)

Shore Collaborative Report: Should this be a report on out of district placement?

Jenny Graham: Yes except that Shore is associated with the revolving account. Not all out of district placements are.

Melanie McLaughlin: Looking for aggregated and disaggregated data in this report. How would you define a list of revolving accounts?

Jenny Graham: It is any instance where we are taking in revenue. Accounts are set up to take money in and pay money out. There are legal and compliance issues on how the money can be spent. We are working to spell out these processes. How do we account for all the money coming in and going out?

Paul Ruseau: Is there a motion to approve this to send to the full committee and have all question marks filled in?

Jenny Graham first. Melanie McLaughlin seconded it.

4:31 Jenny Graham/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau: 3 affirmative. Policy gets sent to the full committee.

2) Policies that will be considered: Paul Ruseau making edit on google doc versions of policies and sharing on screen:

JB - EQUAL EDUCATIONAL OPPORTUNITIES (UPDATE)

Motion to Approve: Jenny Graham, Melanie McLaughlin, Paul Ruseau 3 affirmative. Policy gets sent to the full committee.

JFABD - POLICY AND PROCEDURES HOMELESS STUDENT SUPPORT SERVICES (UPDATE)

Jenny Graham/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau: 3 affirmative. Policy gets sent to the full committee.

JFABE - STUDENTS WHO MOVE IN THE MIDDLE OF THE SCHOOL YEAR (REPLACEMENT/CORRECTION TO 'EDUCATIONAL OPPORTUNITIES FOR MILITARY CHILDREN' AND "EDUCATIONAL OPPORTUNITIES FOR CHILDREN IN FOSTER CARE"

Jenny Graham: What about Pre-K?

Melanie McLaughlin: What about post grad - transition students?

Paul Ruseau: I will take this as a to do and see what the Interstate Compact intends? We can always amend it later but we want to have this ready for the audit.

MOTION TO APPROVE WITH NOTE ABOUT POTENTIAL AMENDMENT: Jenny Graham, Melanie McLaughlin, PR 3 affirmative. Policy gets sent to the full committee.

GBEBC - GIFTS TO AND SOLICITATIONS BY STAFF (UPDATE) MOTION TO APPROVE:
Jenny Graham, Melanie McLaughlin, Paul Ruseau 3 affirmative. Policy gets sent to the full committee.

GBEBD - ONLINE FUNDRAISING AND SOLICITATIONS - CROWDFUNDING (NEW)

Jenny Graham: It would be nice to have a report on fundraising that teachers do for classrooms so we know of deficiencies in our budget.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: We have been clear that when people are using gofundme, we need to know so that we can make sure it is being used for the original intent. We need to be aware if the items don't end up being used with students. There can be duplication of efforts as well. We are not trying to stifle people with what is available but it needs to be aligned with what the schools actually need. Principals need to be involved. It needs to be labeled MPS. Items need to be cataloged and not leave if the teacher leaves.

Peter Cushing: This is the high level policy but internally we need to create an internal procedure/form to be filed in the central office. There is no mechanism now for allowing/not allowing some donations from organizations (such as one that fundraises to give extra monitors to teachers). Our procedure would have an end of run piece.

MOTION TO APPROVE: Jenny Graham/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau: 3 affirmative.
Policy gets sent to the full committee.

Will include a report from the central office.

GBEBC - GIFTS TO AND SOLICITATIONS BY STAFF (UPDATE)

MOTION TO APPROVE: Jenny Graham/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau: 3 affirmative.
Policy gets sent to the full committee.

FOSTER CARE POLICY: JFABF from MASC

MOTION TO APPROVE: Jenny Graham/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau: 3 affirmative.
Policy gets sent to the full committee.

Melanie McLaughlin: Next time can we provide more information on the audit.

DESE is conducting an Educational Stability Program Review of all districts. Medford is part of the first 60 districts to be evaluated. DESE would like all districts to adopt policies for the Military, Foster Care and Homeless that are ESSA compliant. They suggest that we utilize policies from MASC dated October 2019. The documents you provide to the SC tonight meet those qualifications.

Paul Ruseau: In future, we will provide more details with links to policies in question on agenda.

MOTION TO ADJOURN: Melanie McLaughlin/Jenny Graham

ROLL Jenny Graham/Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau: 3 affirmative